



Shelby the Sea Turtle Bag Charm

A keyring & bag charm crochet pattern

US terms

Easy

30 minutes

3.7 cm / 1.5 in across

A thirty-minute sea turtle in DK cotton: a domed shell, a flat underside with the head and four flippers worked as bumps in one round, joined edge to edge.

24

stitches: shell and
underside match

5

bumps: 1 head,
4 flippers

203

stitches in the
whole charm

2

sizes: 3.7 cm
and 5.7 cm

Welcome

A thirty-minute sea turtle charm in DK cotton. The shell is a small dome, the underside is a flat disc whose last round grows the head and four flippers as five bumps, and the two are crocheted together edge to edge around a pinch of stuffing. Add a split ring and Shelby lives on your keys or bag.

3.7 cm

ACROSS THE FLIPPERS

3.2 cm

LONG

30 min

START TO FINISH

~3 g

OF DK COTTON

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Shelby: a domed shell over a flat underside with five bumps.

1 · Materials

Shell yarn	DK (#3) cotton, sage green, about 2 g.
Body yarn	DK (#3) cotton, cream or pale sand, about 1.5 g.
Hook & eyes	2.5 mm (US B/1 - C/2). Two 4 mm safety eyes, or two black French knots.
Also	A pinch of fibre filling; yarn needle; stitch marker; a 25 mm split ring or lobster-clasp keychain; dark green floss for the shell markings.



Shell and underside joined edge to edge with a pinch of stuffing.

GAUGE & SIZE

24 sc around measures about 27 mm across in DK on 2.5 mm (3.5 mm per stitch, 3.2 mm per round). The shell dome is about 27 mm wide; with the flippers Shelby spans about 37 mm and is 32 mm long. Gauge is not critical for a charm.

Abbreviations (US terms)

MR magic ring	ch chain
sc single crochet	hdc half double crochet
inc increase (2 sc in one st)	sl st slip stitch
BLO back loop only	(sc, hdc, sc) in next three stitches in one stitch - a bump
FO fasten off	st(s) stitch(es)
(n) stitch count at round end	

2 · Techniques

Everything this pattern uses, in the order you will meet it.

1

Magic ring & spiral

Both discs start with a magic ring and are worked in a spiral. Move the marker every round.

2

The back-loop rim

The shell's last round is worked in back loops only. The free front loops make a neat ridge around the rim that reads as the shell edge, and the join is worked into those same free loops.

3

Bumps in one round

The underside's last round works (sc, hdc, sc) or (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) into single stitches at five points. Each cluster consumes ONE stitch of the round below and produces three or four - the head is the four-stitch bump, the flippers are three-stitch bumps.

4

Joining edge to edge

Hold the shell over the underside, wrong sides together, and sc through both layers around: one stitch of shell rim to one stitch of underside - but at each bump, work the bump stitches into the SAME shell stitch so the bumps stay free. Stuff before the last few stitches.

3 · Shell – main colour

A 24-stitch dome with a back-loop rim. Embroider the shell markings before joining - it is easier flat.

Shell · sage

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[1 sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	dome at full width
R5	BLO sc in each st around	(24)	rim - back loops only
R6	sc in each st around	(24)	



Shelby: a domed shell over a flat underside with five bumps.

FO leaving a 30 cm tail for the join. With dark green floss, embroider a hexagon pattern: six short V shapes around R2-R3 and a ring of short lines at R4. 24 stitches; about 27 mm across.

4 · Underside, head & flippers - contrast

A flat 24-stitch disc. The fifth round grows the head and flippers as five bumps and takes the count from 24 to 35.

Underside · cream

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[1 sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	flat disc, matches the shell
R5	3 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next, 4 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next	(35)	head + 4 flippers



The cluster round: one head bump of four, four flipper bumps of three.

Do not fasten off - the join continues from here. Count check: 3 + 4 + 4 + 4 + 4 = 19 plain stitches plus 5 cluster anchors = 24 consumed; 19 + 4 (head) + 12 (four flippers) = 35 produced.

- Head - the 4-stitch bump (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) is the head. Insert the 4 mm eyes into the two hdc of the head bump, or embroider French knots there after joining.
- Flippers - the four 3-stitch bumps are the flippers; the pairs sit 4 stitches apart along each side, front pair closest to the head.

READING THE CLUSTER ROUND

Each bracketed group goes into ONE stitch. So the round is: 3 plain, head bump, 4 plain, flipper, 4 plain, flipper, 4 plain, flipper, 4 plain, flipper - and that is the end of the round. There is no plain stitch after the last flipper; the next stitch you work is the first stitch of the join.

5 · Joining & the bigger Shelby

Join shell to underside with single crochet through both layers, working the bumps into single shell stitches so they stand free.

- Hold the shell on top of the underside, right sides out, head bump at the front. Continuing with the cream yarn from R5, sc through the free front loops of the shell's R5 rim and the underside's R5 stitches together.
- Plain to plain: one shell stitch with one underside stitch. At a bump: work all the bump's stitches (3, or 4 for the head) into the SAME single shell stitch - so a 3-stitch flipper uses one shell stitch and the 24 shell stitches match the 24 anchors below. Shell rim 24 = underside anchors 24; the bumps ride on top.
- Stop 5 stitches before the end, push in a pinch of stuffing with the hook handle, then finish the round. Sl st in the first stitch, FO and bury the tail between the layers.
- Eyes and face - if you are embroidering, make two black French knots on the head bump now, and a tiny smile below them if you like.
- Charm loop - with the shell yarn, join with a sl st at the centre back of the shell rim (opposite the head), ch 12, sl st in the same stitch, FO and knot inside. Thread the split ring or clasp through the chain loop.
- Bigger Shelby (~5.7 cm across). Work the shell to 42 stitches: R1 6, R2 12, R3 18, R4 24, R5 [3 sc, inc] x 6 (30), R6 [4 sc, inc] x 6 (36), R7 [5 sc, inc] x 6 (42), R8 BLO (42), R9 sc around (42). Underside R1-R7 the same to 42, do not fasten off. Rnd 8: 7 sc, (sc, hdc, hdc, sc) in next, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next, 8 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next, 7 sc, (sc, hdc, sc) in next = 53, consuming 42 anchors. Join 42 to 42 by the same rule. Allow 45-50 minutes and ~4 g.



Shell and underside joined edge to edge with a pinch of stuffing.

6 · Assembly & finishing

BEFORE YOU SEW - LAY EVERY COMPONENT OUT AND CHECK

1 shell (24 sts, BLO rim) · 1 underside with 5 bumps (35 sts) · 2 eyes or floss · 1 split ring / clasp · a pinch of stuffing

Shell markings

Embroider before joining, on the flat shell: six V shapes around R2-R3 and short dashes at R4 in dark green floss.

Eyes

4 mm safety eyes in the two hdc of the head bump before joining, or French knots after.

Join

Cream yarn, sc through both layers round the rim; bumps into single shell stitches; stuff 5 stitches before the end.

Loop & ring

Ch-12 loop at the back of the shell rim; split ring or lobster clasp through it.

Check

Shelby should sit flat on the table with all four flippers touching and the head slightly raised by the shell's dome.



7 · Troubleshooting

The cluster round does not come out at 35. Nineteen plain stitches and five anchors consume the 24; $19 + 4$ (head) + 12 (four flippers) = 35. If you ended with stitches to spare, one plain run is too short; if you ran out, you worked a plain stitch after the last flipper.

Flippers get sewn into the seam. At each bump work ALL its stitches into one shell stitch - do not spread them over three shell stitches, or the bump gets pulled flat into the rim.

Shelby is domed the wrong way. The BLO round is the shell's rim and its free loops face the underside. If the ridge is on top, you joined through the wrong loops - the join should sit under the rim, not on it.

Colourways



Sage



Teal



Mustard



Rust



Ocean blue



Left to right: sage, teal, mustard, rust, ocean blue shells - all with a cream underside and dark green or brown markings.

8 · Terms of use

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